

SOCIALSPHEAR

SocialSphear — Product Requirements Document v1.0

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Document Information

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Revision History

Version	Date	Author	Summary of Changes
0.1	May 2026	Dipesh	Initial draft — vision and problem statement
0.9	June 2026	Dipesh	Added tech stack, user personas, competitive analysis
1.0	June 2026	Dipesh	Full PRD — requirements, features, roadmap, success metrics

1. Executive Summary

SocialSphear is a next-generation social media management and scheduling platform built for content creators, influencers, marketing agencies, startups, and businesses. The platform enables users to connect all their social media accounts, create content once, schedule posts across multiple platforms, and automatically publish content — all from a single unified workspace.

Unlike existing incumbents built on 2008–2014 stacks (Buffer, Hootsuite, Later, Sprout Social), SocialSphear is built ground-up on a fully TypeScript-native modern stack with no legacy debt. This structural advantage allows the team to ship AI-powered features that legacy competitors cannot economically replicate.

MISSION

Eliminate the need for creators and businesses to manually log into and post on every social platform separately — saving hours every week and enabling smarter, data-driven content strategies.

Metric	Target (Year 1)	Target (Year 2)
Monthly Active Users	5,000	50,000
Monthly Recurring Revenue	\$25,000	\$500,000
Paying Customers	500	5,000
Supported Platforms	10	20+
Net Promoter Score	40+	60+

2. Problem Statement

2.1 The Core Problem

Content creators, influencers, businesses, and agencies spend enormous time on repetitive, manual social media tasks that should be automated. The average social media manager spends 6+ hours per week on tasks that could be eliminated with the right tooling.

2.2 Pain Points by User Type

Content Creators and Influencers

- Must log into 4–8 different platforms daily to post identical content
- Cannot preview how content looks across different platforms before posting
- No centralised way to track engagement across all platforms
- Manually adapting captions, hashtags, and formats per platform
- No AI assistance for generating platform-optimised captions

Marketing Agencies

- Managing 10–50+ client accounts across multiple platforms simultaneously
- Per-seat pricing of Hootsuite (\$99/seat) and Sprout Social (\$199/seat) makes team scaling prohibitively expensive
- No white-label options for client-facing dashboards
- Approval workflows are fragmented — content sits in email chains
- Client reporting requires manual data export and formatting

Small Businesses and Startups

- Cannot afford enterprise tools at \$200–\$400/seat/month
- Free tools lack scheduling reliability and analytics depth
- No AI tools to help resource-constrained teams produce quality content
- Social media accounts go unmonitored — missed engagement opportunities

2.3 Market Opportunity

Segment	Global Market Size	CAGR	Opportunity
Social Media Management Software	\$23.4B (2026)	22.4%	\$85B by 2032
AI Content Creation Tools	\$4.7B (2026)	28.6%	\$18B by 2030
Marketing Automation	\$9.5B (2026)	12.8%	\$19B by 2030
Creator Economy	\$250B (2026)	35%	\$480B by 2028

3. Target Users and Personas

3.1 Primary Personas

Persona 1 — The Independent Creator

Attribute	Details
Name	Priya Sharma
Age	26
Role	Lifestyle and Fashion Creator
Platforms	Instagram, TikTok, YouTube, Pinterest
Followers	85,000 across all platforms
Tech comfort	High — uses Canva, CapCut, Notion daily
Budget	\$20–\$60/month for tools
Core pain	Spends 2 hours every morning manually posting the same content to 4 platforms
Key goal	Batch-create content on Sunday, auto-publish all week, review analytics on Friday

Persona 2 — The Social Media Agency

Attribute	Details
Company	BrightPost Agency
Team size	12 people
Clients	25 business clients
Platforms managed	150+ social accounts
Current tool	Hootsuite Advanced — paying \$2,988/month for 12 seats
Core pain	Per-seat pricing means adding one team member costs \$249/month extra
Key goal	One workspace per client, unlimited team members on one flat plan, white-label reports

Persona 3 — The Small Business Owner

Attribute	Details
Name	Marcus Reid
Business	Local gym — 3 locations
Platforms	Facebook, Instagram, Google Business
Team	1 part-time social media helper
Current tool	Nothing — posting manually when they remember

Attribute	Details
Core pain	Inconsistent posting means low organic reach; no time to create content
Key goal	AI writes captions, schedule 2 weeks of content in one sitting, auto-post

Persona 4 — The Growth-Stage Startup

Attribute	Details
Company	NovaPay (Fintech SaaS)
Marketing team	3 people
Platforms	LinkedIn, Twitter/X, Instagram, YouTube
Current tool	Buffer Essentials
Core pain	No approval workflow — anyone can post anything; no competitor monitoring
Key goal	Approval workflow with CEO sign-off, AI brand voice consistency, competitor tracking

4. Competitive Analysis

4.1 Competitor Overview

Competitor	Founded	Pricing Model	Starting Price	Key Weakness
Buffer	2010	Per-channel	\$5/channel/mo	No social listening, weak AI
Hootsuite	2008	Per-seat	\$99/seat/mo	Expensive, legacy UI, cluttered
Later	2014	Per social set	\$25/mo	Visual-only, no AI generation
Sprout Social	2010	Per-seat	\$199/seat/mo	Prohibitively expensive for SMBs
Postiz	2023	Per channel	\$29/mo	Rough UI, no free cloud plan

4.2 Feature Gap Analysis

Feature	Buffer	Hootsuite	Later	Sprout	Postiz	SocialSphear
AI caption generation	Basic	Basic	No	Basic	Yes	Advanced
AI image generation	No	No	No	No	Yes	Yes
Social listening	No	Yes	Partial	Yes	No	Yes (v2)
Flat-rate team pricing	No	No	No	No	Partial	Yes
White-label reports	No	Enterprise	No	Enterprise	No	Yes
Content calendar	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes
Approval workflow	Team plan	Yes	Limited	Yes	No	Yes
AI scheduling (best time)	Basic	Yes	Yes	Yes	No	Advanced
Open API	No	Enterprise	No	Enterprise	Yes	Yes (all plans)

POSITION	SocialSphear is the only social media management platform that combines enterprise-grade scheduling reliability, genuine AI content generation, and agency-friendly flat-rate workspace pricing — without the legacy complexity or per-seat cost traps of Hootsuite and Sprout Social.
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5. Product Vision and Goals

5.1 Vision

SocialSphear will become the default social media management platform for the next generation of creators, agencies, and businesses — the way Figma became the default for designers and Notion for knowledge work.

5.2 Strategic Goals

Year 1 — Foundation

- Launch MVP with scheduling, calendar, and AI captions for 10 platforms
- Acquire 500 paying customers at \$49 average MRR per customer
- Achieve NPS of 40+ with sub-2-second schedule reliability
- Build content creator community with 5,000 free users

Year 2 — Growth

- Launch agency workspace with white-label reports
- Add social listening and competitor tracking features
- Reach \$500,000 MRR and 5,000 paying customers
- Launch public API and integration marketplace

Year 3 — Scale

- Expand to 30+ supported social platforms
- Launch AI content agent that plans, creates, and schedules autonomously
- Pursue Series A funding at \$50M+ ARR trajectory

5.3 Success Metrics

Category	Metric	Target (Month 6)	Target (Month 12)
Activation	Users who schedule first post within 24h of signup	60%	75%
Retention	Month-3 retention rate	55%	70%
Revenue	Monthly Recurring Revenue	\$10,000	\$25,000
Reliability	Post delivery success rate	99.5%	99.9%
Satisfaction	Net Promoter Score	35	50
Engagement	Posts scheduled per active user per month	20	40
Growth	Month-over-month user growth rate	15%	20%

6. Feature Requirements

Features are organised by priority tier. P0 (MVP) must ship at launch. P1 ships within 90 days post-launch. P2 targets the 6-month mark.

6.1 P0 — MVP Features (Launch)

6.1.1 Social Account Connection

- OAuth 2.0 connection for Instagram, Facebook, Twitter/X, LinkedIn, TikTok, Pinterest, YouTube, Google Business, Threads, BlueSky
- Automatic token refresh handling when OAuth tokens expire
- Account health status indicator: connected, expiring, or disconnected
- Support multiple accounts per platform per workspace
- Secure AES-256 encrypted storage of all OAuth tokens

6.1.2 Content Composer

- Rich text editor with real-time character counter per platform
- Platform-specific character limits enforced live (Twitter 280, LinkedIn 3000, etc.)
- Media upload: images (JPG, PNG, GIF, WebP), videos (MP4, MOV) up to 500MB
- Automatic image resizing per platform format: 1:1, 16:9, 9:16, 4:5
- Multi-image carousel creation for Instagram and LinkedIn
- Hashtag input with auto-suggestions powered by Typesense
- Platform preview: see exactly how the post looks on each platform before publishing
- Draft auto-save every 30 seconds

6.1.3 Post Scheduling

- Schedule posts to one or multiple platforms simultaneously
- Date and time picker with timezone support
- AI-powered best time to post suggestion based on historical engagement
- Immediate publish option (Post Now)
- Queue mode: drop posts into a pre-configured daily publishing queue
- Recurring post support (weekly, monthly)
- Post delivery confirmation with timestamp logging
- 3 automatic retries with exponential backoff on API failure
- Failed post alert via email and in-app notification

6.1.4 Content Calendar

- Month, week, and day calendar views
- Drag-and-drop to reschedule posts
- Per-platform colour coding

- Filter by platform and status: scheduled, published, failed, draft
- Bulk select and reschedule
- Export calendar as PDF or CSV

6.1.5 AI Caption Generator

- Generate captions in tones: professional, casual, witty, inspirational, educational
- Platform-optimised: auto-adjusts length and format per selected platform
- Hashtag generation: suggests 5–30 relevant hashtags based on content topic
- Brand voice training: user provides 5+ example posts to establish their voice
- Regenerate button: one click to get 3 alternative caption options
- Language support: generate captions in 20+ languages

6.1.6 Basic Analytics Dashboard

- Engagement metrics per post: likes, comments, shares, saves, reach, impressions
- Account-level metrics: follower growth, engagement rate, total reach
- Top-performing posts ranked by engagement rate
- Platform comparison view
- Date range filter: last 7 days, 30 days, 90 days, custom
- Export data as CSV

6.1.7 Team and Workspace Management

- Workspace per brand or client with custom name and logo
- Invite team members by email
- Role-based access: Owner, Admin, Editor, Viewer
- Content approval workflow: Editor submits, Admin approves before scheduling
- Activity log: who posted what and when

6.2 P1 — Post-Launch Features (90 days)

- AI image generation via fal.ai — generate post visuals from text prompts
- Bulk content scheduling via CSV upload
- Link-in-bio page builder (custom landing page aggregating all profile links)
- Instagram grid preview — see how your feed looks before posting
- Unified social inbox — view and reply to comments and DMs from all platforms
- White-label PDF reports for agencies with custom logo, colours, and client name
- RSS auto-posting — connect a blog RSS feed and auto-schedule new posts
- Browser extension — clip content from any webpage to draft queue

6.3 P2 — Six-Month Milestone

- Social listening — monitor brand mentions and keywords across all platforms
- Competitor tracking — track follower growth and posting frequency of up to 5 competitors
- AI content calendar planner — AI suggests a full month's content plan based on goals
- Video caption generation — auto-transcribe and generate video captions
- TikTok and Reels native auto-posting (via official Content Posting APIs)
- Zapier, Make, and n8n integrations via webhook support
- Public REST API with OAuth 2.0 — documented at api.socialsphear.com
- Affiliate programme dashboard

7. Technical Architecture

7.1 Tech Stack Summary

Layer	Technology	Purpose
Frontend Framework	Next.js 15 (App Router)	SSR, routing, API routes
Language	TypeScript (everywhere)	Type safety across entire codebase
UI Components	Shadcn/UI + Tailwind CSS v4	Design system and utility styling
State Management	Zustand + TanStack Query v5	Global state and server data fetching
Animations	Motion (Framer Motion)	Micro-interactions and drag-and-drop
Backend Framework	NestJS	Structured, scalable Node.js API
API Layer	tRPC	End-to-end type-safe API calls
Real-time	Socket.io (WebSockets)	Live notifications and calendar updates
Primary Database	PostgreSQL via Supabase	All relational data storage
ORM	Prisma	Type-safe database queries and migrations
Cache	Redis via Upstash	Sessions, API caching, rate limiting
Analytics DB	ClickHouse Cloud	High-performance analytics queries
Job Queue	BullMQ + Redis	Post scheduling and background jobs
Workflow Engine	Temporal	Complex multi-step workflow orchestration
AI SDK	Vercel AI SDK	Unified interface for all AI models
Text AI	Anthropic Claude API	Caption generation and brand voice
Image AI	fal.ai	AI image generation for posts
AI Agents	LangChain.js	Autonomous content planning agents
Frontend Hosting	Vercel	Global CDN deployment for Next.js
Backend Hosting	Railway	Managed NestJS deployment (scales to AWS EKS later)
Media Storage	Cloudflare R2	Zero-egress-fee image and video storage
Image Processing	Cloudinary	Auto-resize images per platform format
CDN + Security	Cloudflare	DDoS protection, WAF, global CDN
Authentication	Clerk	Auth, teams, roles, OAuth management
Payments	Stripe + Stripe Billing	Subscriptions and billing lifecycle
Email	Resend + React Email	Transactional emails
Search	Typesense	Content library and hashtag search
Error Tracking	Sentry	Real-time error monitoring

Layer	Technology	Purpose
Product Analytics	PostHog	User behaviour, funnels, feature flags
Monorepo	Turborepo	Shared types across frontend and backend
CI/CD	GitHub Actions	Automated test and deploy pipeline
Testing	Vitest + Playwright	Unit and end-to-end testing

8. Pricing Model

8.1 Pricing Philosophy

SocialSphear prices per workspace, not per seat. A team of 10 people managing one brand pays the same as a team of 1. This directly eliminates the biggest pain point with Hootsuite and Sprout Social, and is the strongest pricing differentiator in the market.

8.2 Pricing Tiers

Plan	Price	Channels	Team Members	AI Credits/mo	Key Feature
Free	\$0/mo	3 channels	1 user	20 captions	7-day post history
Creator	\$19/mo	10 channels	3 users	200 captions	AI image gen (20/mo)
Pro	\$49/mo	25 channels	Unlimited	1,000 captions	Approval workflow + analytics
Agency	\$99/mo	100 channels	Unlimited	5,000 captions	White-label reports + API
Enterprise	Custom	Unlimited	Unlimited	Unlimited	SSO + SLA + dedicated support

KEY INSIGHT

At \$99/month flat for an agency, SocialSphear is 30x cheaper than Hootsuite (\$2,988/mo for 12 seats) and 40x cheaper than Sprout Social (\$3,588/mo for 9 seats on Professional). This is the headline number for all agency marketing.

8.3 Add-Ons

Add-On	Price	Details
Extra AI Credits	\$10 / 500 credits	For users who exhaust monthly allowance
Social Listening	\$29/mo	Brand monitoring and competitor tracking (P2 feature)
Extra Channels	\$5/channel/mo	Add individual channels beyond plan limit
Priority Support	\$19/mo	4-hour response SLA, dedicated Slack channel

9. UX and Design Requirements

9.1 Design Principles

- Clarity over cleverness — every action takes no more than 3 clicks
- Speed is a feature — all page loads under 1.5 seconds, calendar interactions under 100ms
- Mobile-first — full scheduling and calendar functionality on mobile browsers
- Accessible — WCAG 2.1 AA compliance for all core flows
- Progressive disclosure — advanced features reveal themselves as users grow

9.2 Onboarding Flow — Target: 5 minutes to first scheduled post

1. Sign up with Google or email via Clerk (30 seconds)
2. Connect first social account via OAuth (60 seconds)
3. Create first post in composer (90 seconds)
4. AI suggests caption — user edits and approves (60 seconds)
5. Schedule post with date picker or Best Time suggestion (30 seconds)
6. Confirmation screen with calendar preview (10 seconds)

9.3 Key Screens

Screen	Purpose	Key Elements
Dashboard	Overview of all account activity	Upcoming posts, recent analytics, quick compose button
Content Composer	Create and schedule posts	Rich editor, platform selector, preview panel, AI assist sidebar
Content Calendar	Visual scheduling overview	Month/week/day view, drag-and-drop, platform filters
Analytics	Performance data and insights	Engagement charts, top posts, platform comparison, date filter
Social Inbox	Manage comments and DMs	Unified feed, reply interface, filter by platform
Workspace Settings	Team and account management	Members list, role editor, billing, connected accounts
AI Studio	AI content creation tools	Caption generator, image generator, brand voice trainer

10. Security and Compliance

10.1 Data Security

- All OAuth tokens encrypted at rest using AES-256 before storing in PostgreSQL
- All data transmitted over TLS 1.3 — no HTTP fallback
- Clerk handles all authentication — no passwords stored in SocialSphear's database
- Media files stored in Cloudflare R2 with private access, served via signed URLs
- Rate limiting on all API endpoints — Redis-backed, per-user and per-IP
- SQL injection prevention via Prisma parameterised queries
- XSS prevention via React's default JSX escaping and Helmet.js headers

10.2 Compliance Targets

Standard	Target Date	Scope
GDPR	Launch	EU user data — right to deletion, data portability, consent management
CCPA	Launch	California users — opt-out of data sale, data access requests
SOC 2 Type I	Month 12	Security, availability, and confidentiality controls audit
SOC 2 Type II	Month 24	12-month operational evidence review
HIPAA	Enterprise tier only	For healthcare clients — Business Associate Agreement required

11. Integrations

11.1 Social Platform Integrations — Launch

Platform	Post Types	Auto-publish	API Version
Instagram	Feed, Stories, Reels	Yes (Graph API)	v21.0
Facebook	Page posts, Stories	Yes	v21.0
Twitter / X	Tweets, Threads	Yes	v2
LinkedIn	Posts, Articles	Yes	v2
TikTok	Videos	Yes (Content Posting API)	v2
Pinterest	Pins, Boards	Yes	v5
YouTube	Community posts	Yes	v3
Google Business	Business posts	Yes	v1
Threads	Text posts, images	Yes	v1
BlueSky	Posts, threads	Yes	AT Protocol

11.2 Third-Party Integrations — Post-Launch

Integration	Type	Priority	Use Case
Zapier	Webhook / OAuth	P1	Connect to 5,000+ apps
Make (Integromat)	Webhook	P1	Advanced automation workflows
n8n	Webhook	P1	Self-hosted automation
Canva	OAuth	P1	Import Canva designs directly to composer
Google Analytics	API	P1	Correlate social traffic with site analytics
Notion	API	P2	Import content drafts from Notion databases
Slack	Webhook	P2	Post approval notifications to Slack channels
HubSpot	API	P2	Sync social leads to HubSpot CRM
Shopify	API	P2	Auto-post new products to social channels

12. Go-to-Market Plan

12.1 Launch Phases

Phase	Timeline	Goal	Key Activities
Alpha	Month 1–2	Internal testing	Build MVP, test all platform APIs, stress-test BullMQ queue
Beta (Closed)	Month 3	50 beta users	Invite creators from Twitter/X and Reddit, collect daily feedback
Beta (Open)	Month 4	500 free users	ProductHunt soft launch, content creator communities
Public Launch	Month 5	1,000 signups	ProductHunt No.1 hunt, Twitter/X launch thread, YouTube demo
Paid Tier Push	Month 6	100 paying customers	Upgrade email campaign, agency cold outreach, affiliate launch

12.2 Acquisition Channels

- Organic SEO — target keywords: social media scheduling tool, Buffer alternative, Hootsuite alternative for agencies
- Content marketing — weekly YouTube tutorials on social media growth and SocialSphear walkthroughs
- Creator community — sponsor newsletters and Discord servers of social media educators
- ProductHunt — coordinated launch with beta user review campaign
- Affiliate programme — 30% recurring commission for referred paying customers
- Agency cold outreach — LinkedIn DMs to social media agency founders with pricing comparison
- Twitter/X presence — founder-led account sharing platform building journey

13. Product Roadmap

Milestone	Target Date	Deliverables	Owner
M1 — Foundation	Month 1, Week 2	Turborepo setup, Next.js + NestJS scaffold, Clerk auth, Supabase PostgreSQL, Prisma schema v1	Engineering
M2 — Social Connect	Month 1, Week 4	OAuth connections for 5 platforms, token storage, account health check	Engineering
M3 — Composer v1	Month 2, Week 2	Post composer, media upload to R2, Cloudinary resizing, platform preview	Engineering + Design
M4 — Scheduler	Month 2, Week 4	BullMQ scheduling, Temporal workflows, post delivery, retry logic, failure alerts	Engineering
M5 — Calendar	Month 3, Week 1	Content calendar with drag-and-drop, filters, week/month/day views	Engineering + Design
M6 — AI Captions	Month 3, Week 2	Claude API integration, tone selector, hashtag generator, brand voice trainer	Engineering
M7 — Analytics	Month 3, Week 4	ClickHouse setup, analytics ingestion, engagement dashboard, CSV export	Engineering
M8 — Team Features	Month 4, Week 1	Workspace management, team roles, approval workflow, activity log	Engineering
M9 — Beta Launch	Month 4, Week 2	Stripe billing integration, all P0 features complete, closed beta	All
M10 — Public Launch	Month 5, Week 1	Open beta, pricing live, ProductHunt launch	All
M11 — P1 Features	Month 5–6	AI image gen, link-in-bio, social inbox, bulk CSV, white-label reports	Engineering
M12 — P2 Features	Month 7–9	Social listening, competitor tracking, AI content planner, public API	Engineering

14. Risks and Mitigations

Risk	Likelihood	Impact	Mitigation
Social platform API changes (e.g. Twitter/X pricing)	High	High	Abstract all platform API calls behind an internal adapter layer — swap platform implementation without changing scheduler logic
Post delivery failure during peak times	Medium	Critical	BullMQ + Temporal retry logic, alerting, 99.9% SLA target backed by dedicated queue monitoring
AI content costs exceed revenue at scale	Medium	Medium	Credit-based AI usage model caps costs per user; negotiate enterprise API pricing at 10k+ users
Competitor launches similar pricing model	Medium	Medium	Network effects from workspaces and analytics data create switching costs; community moat via creator audience
OAuth token theft or breach	Low	Critical	AES-256 encryption at rest, rotate encryption keys quarterly, SOC 2 audit in Year 1
Slow onboarding — users do not connect accounts	High	Medium	Onboarding checklist with progress bar, guided OAuth flow, first post in 5 minutes guarantee
Burn rate exceeds runway before revenue	Medium	Critical	Keep team lean (5 people) for first 12 months, cloud costs under \$2k/mo until 1k paying users

15. Appendix

15.1 Glossary

Term	Definition
Channel	A single connected social media account (e.g. one Instagram profile = one channel)
Workspace	A container for one brand or client — holds their accounts, posts, team, and settings
Seat	A per-user login used by per-seat pricing competitors (SocialSphear does NOT use seat pricing)
Social Listening	Monitoring the internet for mentions of a brand, keyword, or competitor in real time
BullMQ	A Node.js job queue library — the engine that executes scheduled post deliveries
Temporal	A workflow orchestration platform for reliable multi-step, long-running processes
tRPC	A TypeScript library providing end-to-end type safety between frontend and backend
ClickHouse	A columnar analytics database optimised for fast aggregation over billions of rows
OAuth 2.0	The authentication protocol used to connect social accounts without storing passwords
MRR	Monthly Recurring Revenue — the total predictable monthly subscription income
NPS	Net Promoter Score — measures user loyalty via how likely would you recommend this (0–10)
ARR	Annual Recurring Revenue — MRR multiplied by 12